Universal gravitational energy

antocciphysics

Name: _____ **Block:** _____ (teacher only) **Mastery Rating:** _____

LEARNING TARGET Use the zero-at-infinity convention for gravitational potential energy.

SUCCESS CRITERIA - I can...

1. Use center-to-center distance.
2. Explain why negative potential energy does not mean negative kinetic energy.
3. Compute changes from final minus initial energy.

Core: teacher selects from 1-7. **Stretch:** 8 after checking your work.

MARZANO SELF-CHECK

① Need help starting

② Can do part; need help

③ Solve and explain with allowed supports

01 Warm-up: bring back an earlier idea

A cart's work is measured over the first 3 m, but its speed change is measured over 5 m. Can these values directly test $W_{net}=\Delta K$? Explain.

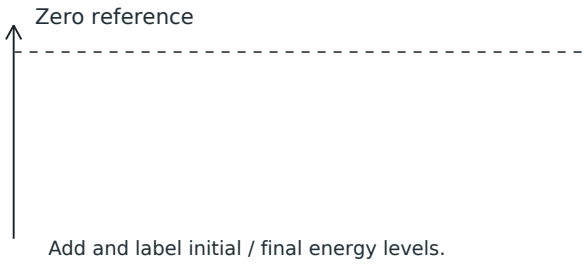
Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

02 Worked example: explain the model

Reference: $U = -GMm/r$; $\Delta U = U_f - U_i$.
Outside a spherical source; choose U = 0 at infinity. Moving outward makes U less negative.

Worked reasoning: For a supplied source with GMm=120 J·m, potential energy is U=-120/r. At r=3 m, U=-40 J; at 6 m, U=-20 J. Moving outward raises U by 20 J.

Your turn: Draw an energy number line and mark the direction toward the zero at infinite separation.

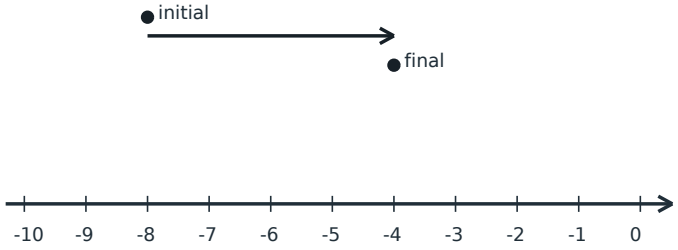


Label energies relative to U = 0 at infinite separation.

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

03 Read and interpret the model

An object moves outward from r to 2 r. Does gravitational potential energy become more or less negative? Draw a number-line comparison.

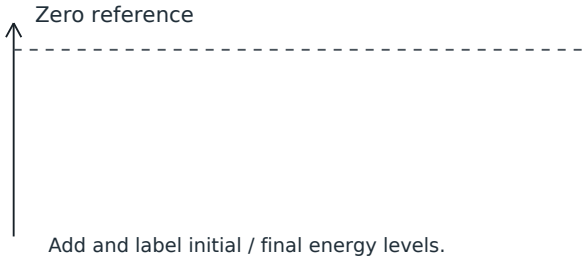


Example: potential energy (J)

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

04 Apply the physics

A gravity simulation uses GMm = 24 J·m and U = 0 at infinite separation. Find U at center distances 3 m and 6 m, then ΔU for the outward move. Place both energies on the energy-level model.



Label energies relative to U = 0 at infinite separation.

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

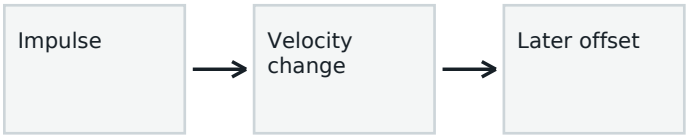
05 Explain your reasoning

A student says “negative potential energy means the object has negative kinetic energy.” Correct the claim.

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

06 Review: connect an earlier idea

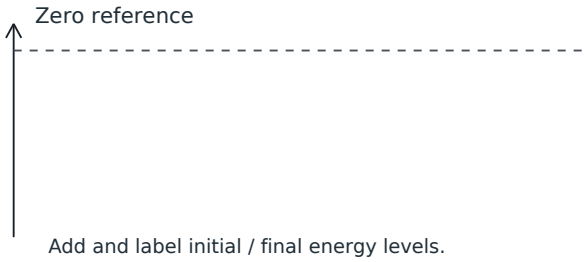
In the same straight-line deflection model, keep sideways Δv fixed but make lead time 4 times as long. Compare shift and name a limitation.
Label the quantities in the model and state its assumptions.



Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

07 Exit check

U changes from -10 J to -6 J. Calculate ΔU and state whether the object gained gravitational energy.

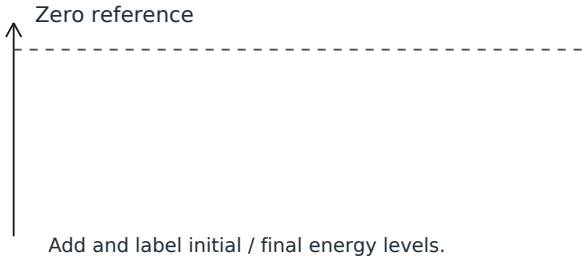


Label energies relative to U = 0 at infinite separation.

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

08 STRETCH: test the model

Return to the worked example in problem 2. Use the same numerator to find U at 4 and 12 m. Is the energy change positive or negative when moving outward?



Label energies relative to U = 0 at infinite separation.

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3